



Delaware County Council Meeting January 4th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDGpkCs7j-w
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 4, 2021

Body: Delaware County Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the meeting at approximately 10:02 a.m. on January 4, 2021, and led the assembly in the Pledge of Allegiance. Public inquiries were directed to the county council website at countycouncil-dist@co.delaware.in.us.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush (virtual), Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander, Mr. Hughes.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Scott Alexander (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by member Steve.

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Minutes for the regular meetings of November 24, 2020, and December 8, 2020, were approved by roll call vote (5-2, with certain members abstaining due to absence or not being in office at the time).
 - Minutes for the special meeting on December 16, 2020, were separately approved by roll call vote, following abstentions from members not present or not yet in office.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:01:45 Election of Council Officers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steve Craycraft, County Auditor.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The council held annual leadership elections. Nominations were closed, and votes were cast for council president and vice president.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - **Scott Alexander** was elected Council President for 2021 by unanimous roll call vote.
 - **Jessica Piper** was elected Council Vice President for 2021 by unanimous roll call vote.

00:09:44 Highway Department Financial Transfer

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** James King (Commissioner) / Highway Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The council discussed a budget transfer for the Highway Department utilizing funds from health insurance line items (noting an existing surplus because departments were instructed to add 10% during July budgeting) to cover staffing adjustments, including 1 payroll clerk and 2 truck driver positions. Commissioner James King explained operational needs including snow plowing, paving, and brush clearing. Council members discussed prior budget cycle lessons.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:18:41 Amendment to Salary and Hiring Freeze Ordinances

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Leadership / Bill Hughes.
- **Deliberation Summary:** A motion was made to approve financial transfers into the amended salary ordinance with corresponding reductions, and to amend hiring freeze ordinance 2020-015.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:19:54 Annual Board and Commission Appointments

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President Scott Alexander.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed and voted on annual reappointments and new appointments to various local boards and commissions, including the Alcohol Beverage Board, Animal Control Board, Community Corrections, Economic Development boards, Housing Authority, Redevelopment Commission, and Tax Abatement Committee. Council member Ron Ballard raised concerns regarding recent commissioner actions concerning the tourism commission appointments; attorney Bill Hughes agreed to research the matter.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: No in-person floor comments from the public were recorded during this session. Public communications were noted as being handled via email and the council's Facebook page, where inquiries regarding new member Ryan Webb's at-large council role were addressed.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Council liaisons were distributed in print to members; members were instructed to notify leadership if changes were requested.
 - Newly elected at-large member Ryan Webb was formally introduced and welcomed to the council.
 - **Adjournment:** Following final business and closing remarks welcoming new members, a motion to adjourn was made and seconded by Mr. Ballard and Ms. Piper, passing by roll call vote.
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